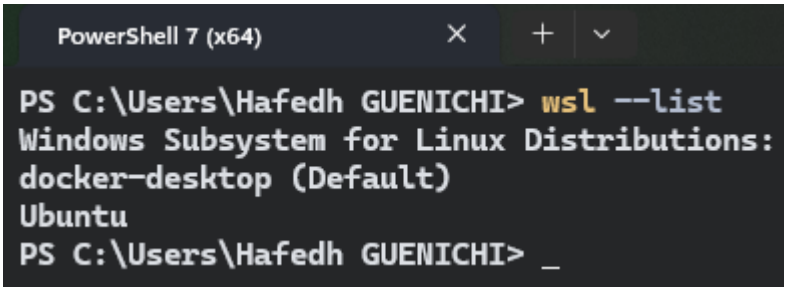
🧠 Overleaf Toolkit Quick-Start Guide

This guide assumes you're running **Ubuntu / Debian / Kali / Mint** in a Linux environment (can be WSL).

0️⃣ Install Ubuntu WSL (if not already installed)

```
# Open PowerShell
wsl --install -d Ubuntu
# Launch Ubuntu
wsl -d Ubuntu
```

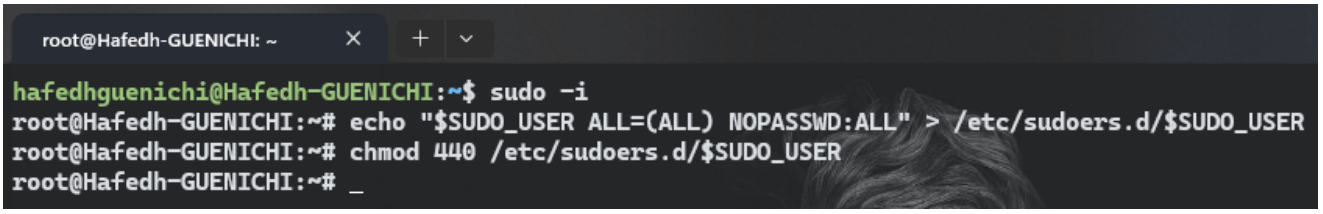


> After installation, your WSL Ubuntu shell is ready to run **docker & Overleaf Toolkit**.

1️⃣ Prepare the System

```
# Optional: become root
sudo -i

# Add passwordless sudo for your user
echo "$SUDO_USER ALL=(ALL) NOPASSWD:ALL" >
/etc/sudoers.d/$SUDO_USER
chmod 440 /etc/sudoers.d/$SUDO_USER
exit
```



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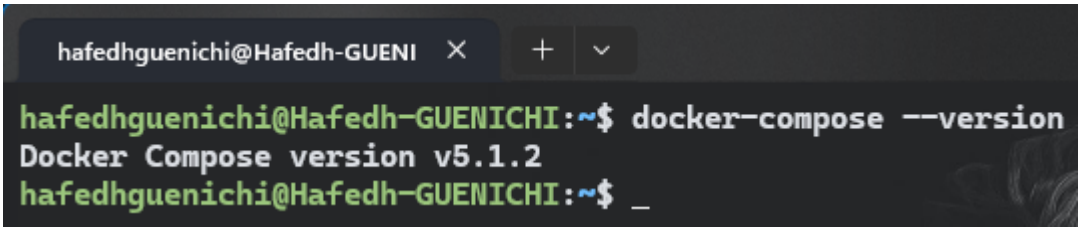
2 Install Docker, Docker Compose v5, and utilities

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install -y docker.io curl wget tree nodejs python3-pip
sudo systemctl start docker
sudo systemctl enable docker
sudo usermod -aG docker $USER
newgrp docker

# Remove old docker-compose v1 if exists
sudo apt remove docker-compose -y

# Configure systemd for docker
sudo nano /etc/wsl.conf
# Then add these lines inside the file
[boot]
systemd=true

# Then exit the wsl
exit

# Shutdown it
wsl --shutdown

# Reopen it again
wsl -d Ubuntu

# Install Docker Compose v5
sudo curl -L
"https://github.com/docker/compose/releases/latest/download/docker-
compose-linux-x86_64" -o /usr/local/bin/docker-compose
sudo chmod +x /usr/local/bin/docker-compose
docker-compose --version   # should show v5.x
```



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3 Clone the Overleaf Toolkit

```
mkdir -p ~/overleaf && cd ~/overleaf
git clone https://github.com/overleaf/toolkit.git ./overleaf-
toolkit
cd overleaf-toolkit
```

```
ls
# bin  CHANGELOG.md  config  data  doc  lib  LICENSE  README.md
```

---

4 Initialise Configuration

```
bin/init
```

Check `config/`:

```
ls config
# overleaf.rc  variables.env  version
```

Edit `config/overleaf.rc`:

```
nano config/overleaf.rc
# Disable sibling containers for CE:
SIBLING_CONTAINERS_ENABLED=false
```

> This is **mandatory for Community Edition**, otherwise CE will fail to start.

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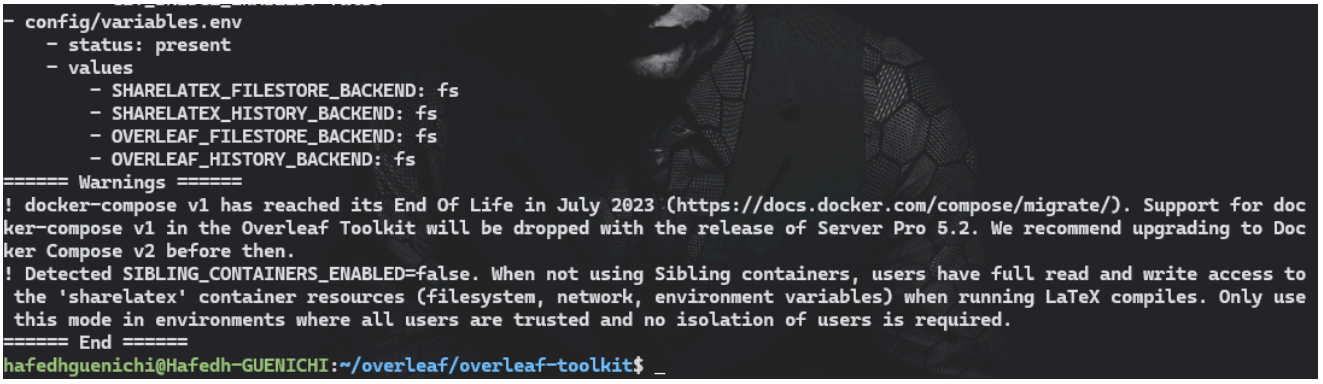
5 Run the Doctor

```
bin/doctor
```

Should output something like:

```
====== Overleaf Doctor ======
- Host Information
```

```
    - Linux
- Dependencies
    - bash
    - docker
    - docker compose
- Configuration
- Warnings: ...
====== End ======
```



---

6 Start Overleaf (Detached Mode)

```
bin/up -d
```

Pulls required docker images (Mongo, Redis, CE) and starts **all containers**

Logs can be followed if needed:

```
bin/logs
# or for multiple services:
bin/logs -f web filestore docstore clsi
```

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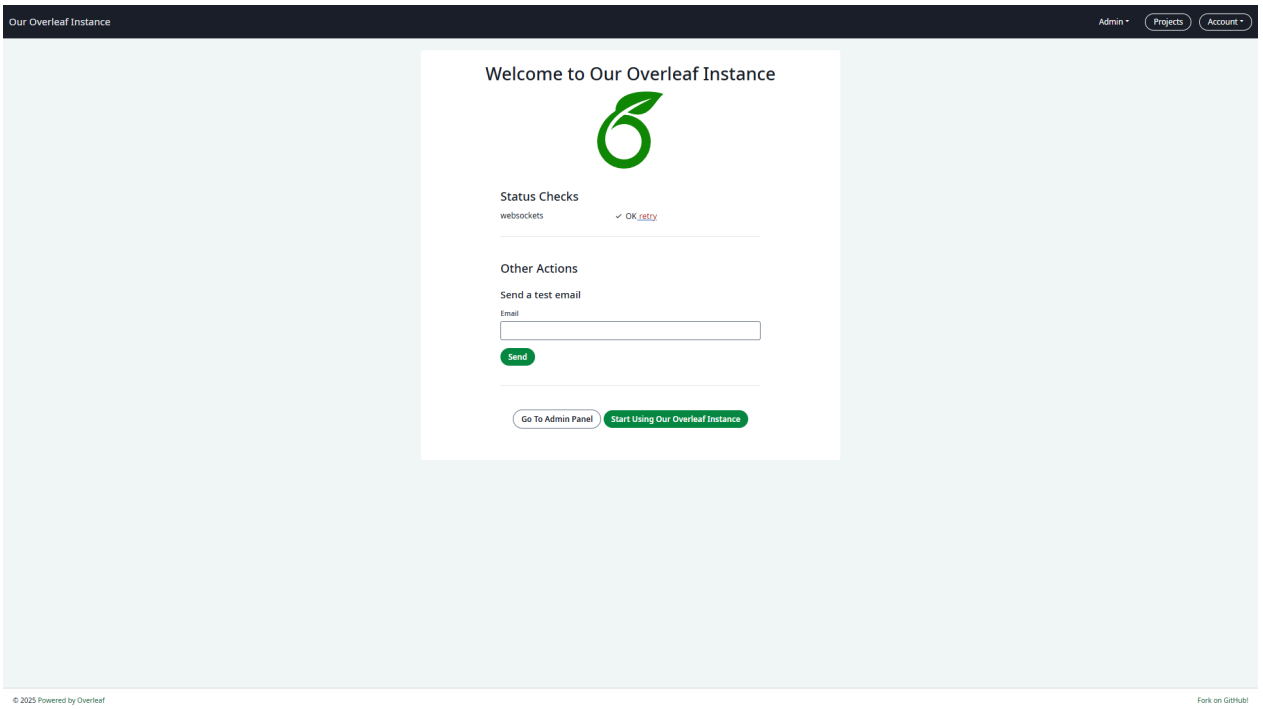
7 Access Launchpad & Create Admin Account

Go to http://localhost/launchpad

Fill in email & password to **create first admin account**

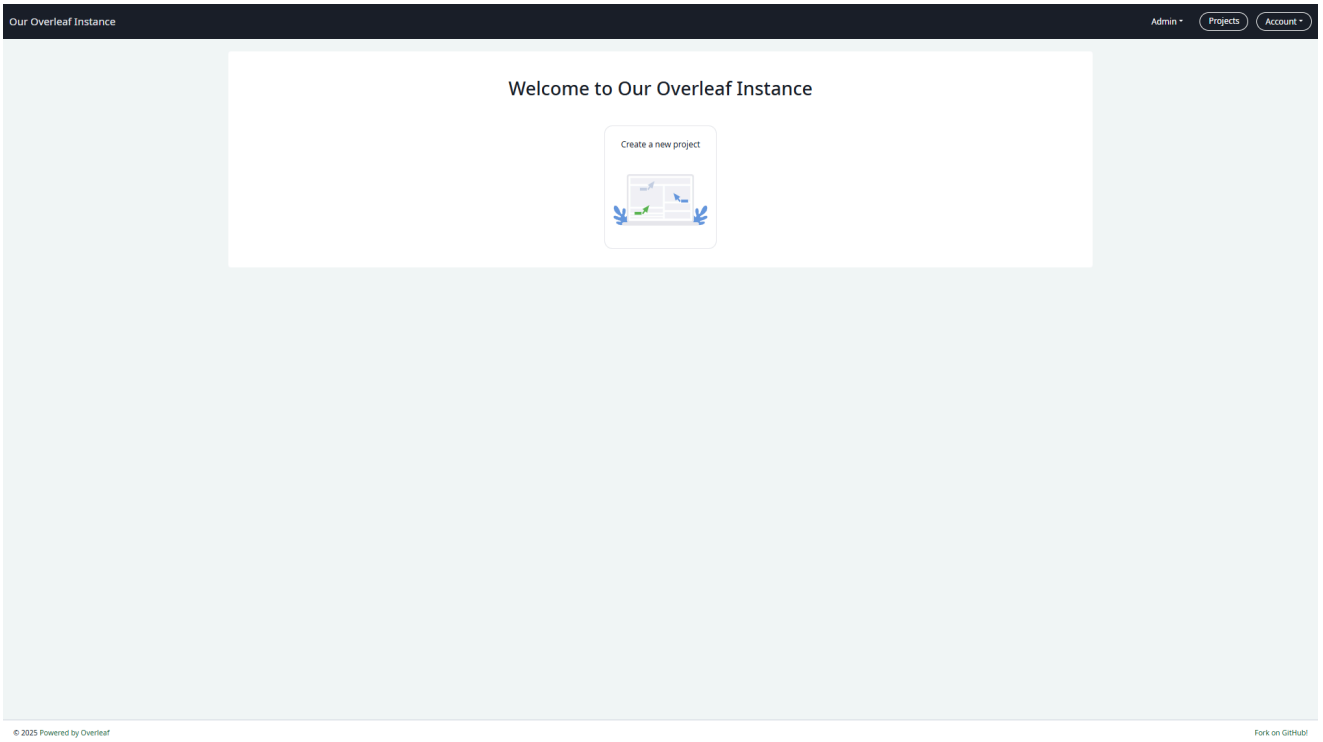
Ignore any test step, just log in and start using Overleaf



8 Create or Import Projects

Go to project page inside Overleaf

Either **import a project** or **create a blank project** for testing/editing



Optional: Install Full TeX Live inside container (~5GB+)

Inside the **sharelatex container**:

```
# Get the container ID
docker ps

# Enter the container
docker exec -it <container_id> bash
```

Update tlmgr to the latest release

```
cd /tmp
curl -LO https://mirror.ctan.org/systems/texlive/tlnet/update-tlmgr-latest.sh
chmod +x update-tlmgr-latest.sh

# Run the updater
./update-tlmgr-latest.sh -- --confirm

# Check version
tlmgr --version
# Example: tlmgr revision 78301 (2026-03-07)
```

Install full TeX Live

```
tlmgr install scheme-full
```

> Installs **all LaTeX packages**, XeLaTeX, LuaLaTeX, fonts, etc.
> Recommended for **Arabic or custom fonts**.
> This may take a while (~5–6GB).
> In the project **File** ~ **Settings** ~ **Compiler** ~ Choose **XeLatex**

Screenshot placeholder – TeX Live installation

```
[1740/4896, 09:36/25:58] install: gentium-otf [3k]
[1741/4896, 09:36/25:58] install: gentium-sil [15166k]
[1742/4896, 09:45/25:41] install: gentle [1k]
[1743/4896, 09:45/25:41] install: gentombow [11k]
[1744/4896, 09:45/25:41] install: geradwp [6k]
[1745/4896, 09:45/25:41] install: german [7k]
[1746/4896, 09:45/25:41] install: germbib [12k]
[1747/4896, 09:45/25:41] install: germkorr [3k]
[1748/4896, 09:46/25:44] install: geschichtsfrkl [6k]
[1749/4896, 09:46/25:44] install: getfiledate [3k]
[1750/4896, 09:46/25:44] install: getitems [2k]
[1751/4896, 09:46/25:44] install: getmap.x86_64-linux [1k]
[1752/4896, 09:47/25:46] install: getmap [8k]
[1753/4896, 09:47/25:46] install: getoptk [5k]
[1754/4896, 09:47/25:46] install: gfdl [13k]
[1755/4896, 09:47/25:46] install: gfnotation [15k]
[1756/4896, 09:47/25:46] install: gfsartemisia [959k]
```